

Natural Earth data uses the geographic coordinate system (projection), WGS84 datum. Natural Earth shapefile character encoding is specified in the code page flag in the shapefile's DBF file; for additional compatibility it is also specified in the CPG file. Natural Earth's WGS84 projection is specified in shapefile's PRJ file.

Natural Earth is a public domain map data set available at 1:10m, 1:50m, and 1:110m scales. Featuring tightly integrated vector and raster data, with Natural Earth you can make a variety of visually pleasing, well-crafted maps with cartography or GIS software. Natural Earth was built through a collaboration of many volunteers and is supported by NACIS (North American Cartographic Information Society). It is free for use in any type of project.

The present map belongs to a category of most detailed maps — major coral reefs from WDB2 or World Data Bank 2. I am using QGIS 3.22 Białowieża version and working using its Python console. I have modified the reefs data set by appending the names of the nearest island and limited the entire list to 98 reefs along the western coast of India, including other countries.

Step 1: Open a new project in QGIS and select 'HCMGIS > BaseMap > Google Satellite Hybrid'.

Step 2: This should load the previously geo-referenced global map on the *Project* view. The moment this is done, *Layers* (left lower section) will show the Google satellite hybrid image. Pan to the western water bodies of India and zoom on the location, as seen in Figure 2.

Step 3: Select all the map files related to the desired features and convert them to .kml using any tool freely available online. You can set the output reference settings to *Lat long Wgs 84* standard and choose to convert. Download the .kml file once conversion is completed. We did it using the tool at <https://products>.

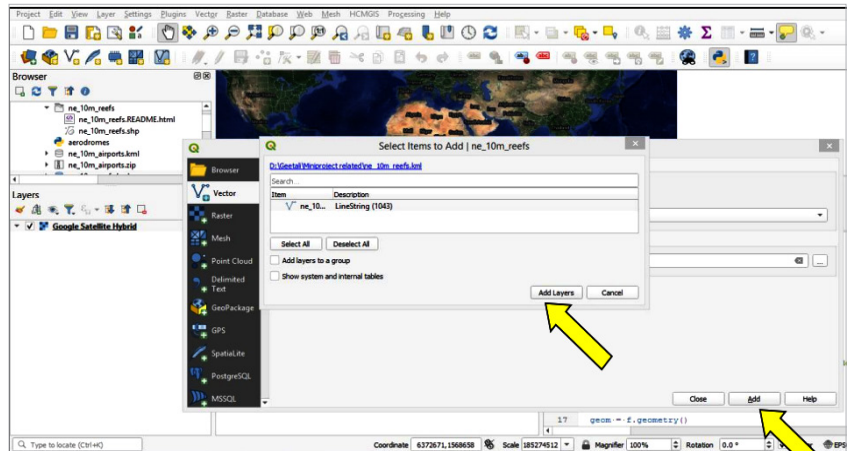


Figure 4: Data source manager

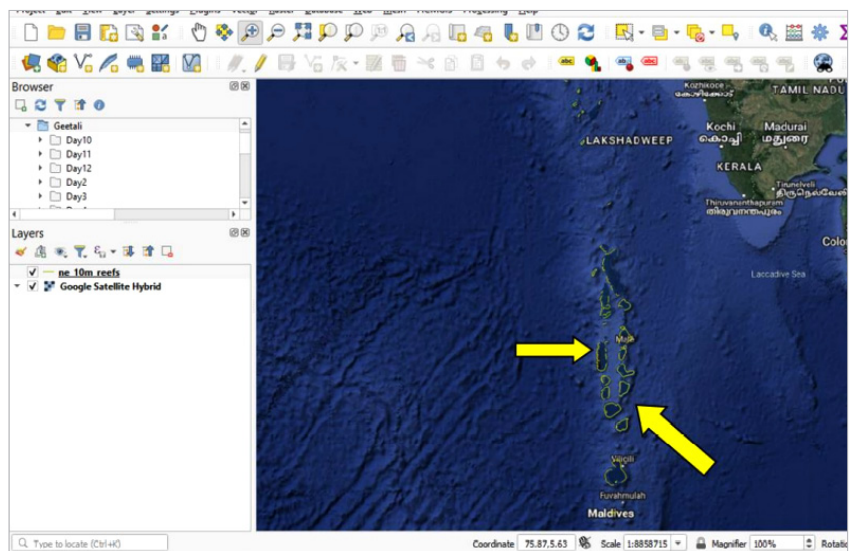


Figure 5: View of the reef details

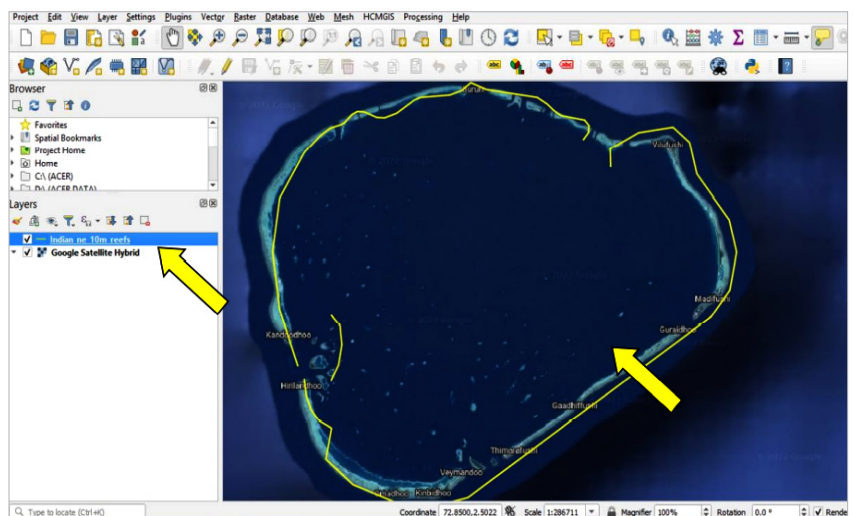


Figure 6: Reefs located on specific islands